- Ignorance and poor maternal nutrition are also contributory factors
- Inadequate food intake
- Vitamin deficiencies
- Chronic starvation

Symptoms of Marasmus

- severe growth retardation
- extreme emaciation
- old man's or monkey's face
- loose hanging skin folds over arms and buttocks
- sunken eyes
- wrinkled skin
- temperature is subnormal
- loss or wasting of muscles,
- ribs become prominent, projected ribs
- digestion becomes weak
- body growth and development slows down.

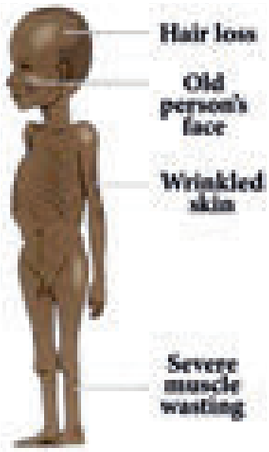


Fig 3.1 Symptoms of Marasmus

It can be cured by ensuring mother's milk for infants, by delaying another pregnancy in quick succession and by having a diet rich in protein, carbohydrates, fats, vitamins and minerals.

Kwashiorkar

Kwashiorkor refers to an **inadequate protein intake with reasonable calorie (energy) intake.** This leads to decreased synthesis of visceral proteins. Kwashiorkor usually occurs at the age of about 12 months when breastfeeding is discontinued, but it can develop at any time during a child's formative years.

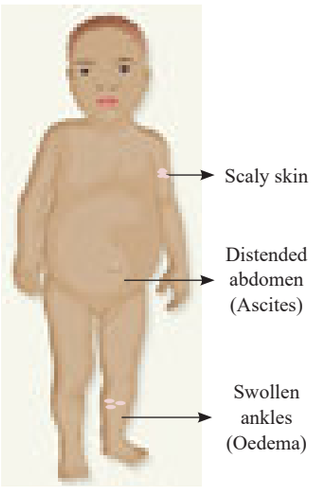


Fig 3.2 Symptoms of kwashiorkor

Causes

Kwashiorkor is most common in areas where there is:

- famine
- limited food supply
- delayed complementary feeding
- protein deficient diet
- infections

Symptoms

The three essential manifestation or signs of kwashiorkor are edema, growth failure and mental changes; in addition there may be changes in hair and skin.

The symptoms of this disease are

- enlargement of liver due to fatty infiltration,
- oedema due to water accumulation
- darkening of the skin with scaly appearance,
- hair becomes reddish-brown,
- legs become thin, and
- retardation of physical as well as mental growth

Eating a protein-rich diet that consists of milk, meat, groundnut, soyabean, jaggery can help in the treatment of kwashiorkor.

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